

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

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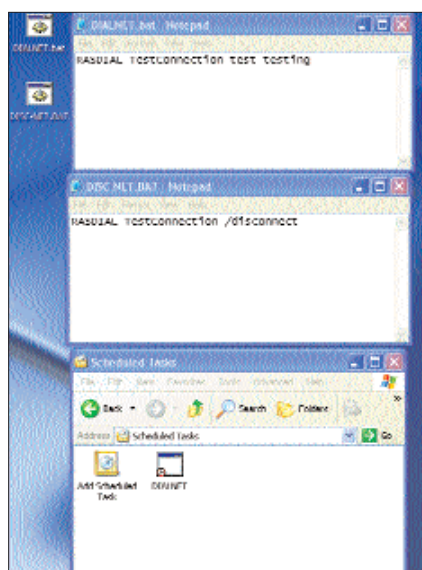
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WINDOWS XP

Vista has already been released, but most of us still use XP—and so, we bring you yet another compilation of tweaks and tips to enhance your experience with XP. Do make a backup of your Registry before trying *any* tip involving Registry changes.

Scheduling Connecting And Disconnecting From Your ISP

With many ISPs using PPPoE-based connections, and many ISPs having awkward schemes such as night-unlimited starting at 2 AM, it's a good idea to schedule your dialling process



Schedule the dialling to your ISP

rather than staying up late at night. Once connected, your downloads can start. You can also schedule to connect to VPNs.

First we create a batch file. Start Notepad (or any other text editor). Enter the following:
RASDIAL <Connection Name>
<Username> <Password>
<Connection Name> should be your exact connection name. Save the file using a suitable name such as "DIALNET.BAT".

Now create a schedule by clicking on Scheduled Tasks in the Control Panel. Double-click on Add Scheduled Task. Click Next. Browse and choose the path of the BAT file. Choose the type of frequency you want the task to run at. Next set the time and date. Finally enter the password for the account running the dialler. You can further make changes to the schedule by right-clicking on the newly-created scheduled task and clicking on Properties.

So why would you want to make changes? Well, many more settings can be applied, and multiple schedules can be allotted. Say you connect between 12 and 8 AM, and then you want it to connect at 1 PM again. Such options are available only once you're done adding the schedule through the Wizard.

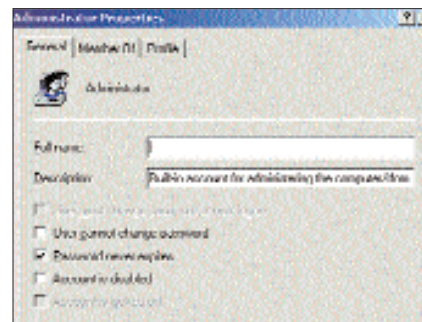
Similar to scheduling a connection, disconnection can be done in the same manner. Some alterations in the batch file creation are needed. First, create a new text file and enter **RASDIAL <Connection Name> /disconnect**

Save the file as a BAT file, for example, "DISC-NET.BAT". Be sure to

enter your exact connection name in place of <Connection Name>. Once again, like the connection schedule, create a schedule in the same manner only this time choose the Disconnecting BAT file.

Disable Expiring Of Windows Passwords

Windows XP Professional's password expires after 42 days. You can disable expiring of Windows passwords if this

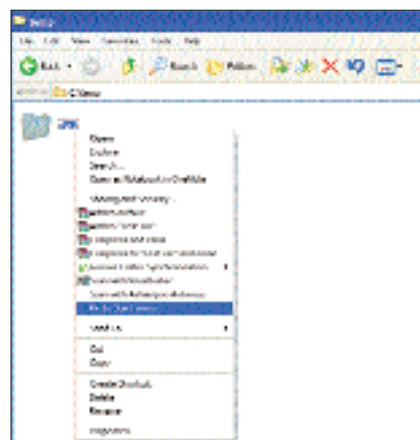


Passwords will never expire again

is a bother. In the Control Panel, double-click on Administrative Tools, then Computer Management. Expand Local Users and Groups. Under Users, right-click on the account of your choice and click Properties. Check the box for "Password never expires".

Enable "Pin to Start menu" For Folders

As it stands, it is only possible to pin programs or shortcuts to the Start Menu, but no folders. To add this, in the Registry Editor, browse to **HKEY_CLASSES_ROOT\Folder\shell\ContextMenuHandlers**. Create a new key by



Now you can pin folders to the Start Menu

right-clicking in the right pane and selecting **New > Key**. Enter "{a2a9545d-a0c2-42b4-9708-a0b2badd77c8}" as the key name. Now that that's done, right-click on any folder in Windows Explorer, and you will see a "Pin to Start menu" option.